# The Foundations of Faith

Explained for the Beginner

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# Introduction

The scholars of this nation have agreed that seeking knowledge is an obligation upon every Muslim, and that the foundation of all knowledge is the knowledge of Allah, His names and His attributes. All praise is due to Allah, the Lord of the worlds.

Whoever reflects upon the condition of the early generations will find that they were the most eager of people in following the Sunnah and the furthest of people from innovations in the religion.

The Messenger of Allah said: "Seeking knowledge is an obligation upon every Muslim."[1] This narration has been graded authentic by the scholars.

It is therefore necessary for the student to begin with the most important matters, then those which follow them in importance, without neglecting the etiquette of learning and acting upon what he learns.

[1] Ibn Majah, no. 224.

# Chapter 1
# The Pillars of Faith

This is the methodology that the righteous predecessors followed, and it is the methodology of the people of the Sunnah in every era, as the author explains in detail in the following pages of this treatise. Faith consists of belief in the heart, statement upon the tongue and action of the limbs.

## 1.1 Belief in Allah

The scholars of this nation have agreed that seeking knowledge is an obligation upon every Muslim, and that the foundation of all knowledge is the knowledge of Allah, His names and His attributes. Belief in Allah includes four matters, which the scholars have listed as follows:

1. Belief in His existence, which is established by the natural disposition and by reason.

2. Belief in His lordship, that He alone is the Creator, the Sovereign and the Disposer of affairs.

3. Belief in His sole right to be worshipped, without any partner.

قل هو الله أحد

"Say: He is Allah, the One." (Qur'an 112:1)

## 1.2 Belief in the Angels

Whoever reflects upon the condition of the early generations will find that they were the most eager of people in following the Sunnah and the furthest of people from innovations in the religion. The angels are a creation of Allah, created from light, and they do

not disobey Him.[1]

SAHIH AL-BUKHARI

It is therefore necessary for the student to begin with the most important matters, then those which follow them in importance, without neglecting the etiquette of learning and acting upon what he learns. Among them is Jibril, who is entrusted with the revelation, and Mika'il, who is entrusted with the rain.

This is the methodology that the righteous predecessors followed, and it is the methodology of the people of the Sunnah in every era, as the author explains in detail in the following pages of this treatise.

[1] Sahih Muslim, no. 2996.

# Chapter 2
# The Pillars of Islam

It is therefore necessary for the student to begin with the most important matters, then those which follow them in importance, without neglecting the etiquette of learning and acting upon what he learns. Islam is built upon five pillars, as reported in the well-known narration of Ibn 'Umar.

## 2.1 The Prayer

The scholars of this nation have agreed that seeking knowledge is an obligation upon every Muslim, and that the foundation of all knowledge is the knowledge of Allah, His names and His attributes. The prayer is the second pillar of Islam and the first matter for which the servant will be held to account.

Whoever reflects upon the condition of the early generations will find that they were the most eager of people in following the Sunnah and the furthest of people from innovations in the religion.

## 2.2 The Fast

This is the methodology that the righteous predecessors followed, and it is the methodology of the people of the Sunnah in every era, as the author explains in detail in the following pages of this treatise. Fasting the month of Ramadan is obligatory upon every adult, sane Muslim who is able to fast.

It is therefore necessary for the student to begin with the most important matters, then those which follow them in importance, without neglecting the etiquette of learning and acting upon what he learns.

# Conclusion

Whoever reflects upon the condition of the early generations will find that they were the most eager of people in following the Sunnah and the furthest of people from innovations in the religion. We ask Allah to make this treatise beneficial for whoever reads it.